

SPEAKING MASTERBOOK

Targeted guidance, worked examples and original practice. Use after an attempt, then transfer the correction to a new context.

A timed performance with four different demands

Part 1: three personal questions, 30 seconds each. Part 2: one photograph and three responses, 45 seconds each. Part 3: two photographs and three responses, 45 seconds each. Part 4: three linked questions, one minute to prepare and two minutes to respond. The component lasts about 12 minutes including instructions and transitions.

The course uses photo briefs because actual photographs and audio files are not included. They support language and timing practice, but they do not reproduce the visual-processing demand of a photograph. A tutor should keep prompts visible and withhold feedback until the section ends.

Use a timer you can control rather than relying on a chat model to enforce exact seconds. Record audio if possible. Pronunciation and intelligibility require an audio sample; a written transcript alone supports feedback on content and language, not a reliable judgement of pronunciation.

Part 1: answer, extend, stop

Give the answer promptly, then add a reason, habit or brief example. For "How do you travel around your area?", name the main method, explain why it suits you and mention one exception. You do not need to describe your entire transport history.

A framework: usual choice -> reason -> concrete detail. Another: present habit -> contrast with the past. These are thinking routes, not scripts. Select the route that fits the question rather than forcing every answer into the same pattern.

If a question asks about a preference, make your preference clear. A general discussion of what other people like may sound fluent while failing to answer the personal question.

Part 2: observe before interpreting

Start with the main scene: who or what is visible, the action and the setting. Add one or two relevant details. Use cautious language for an interpretation: "They may be waiting for instructions" or "It looks as though the event is about to begin."

Do not invent identities, relationships or emotions as facts. "A woman is holding a map" is observable. "She is lost and late for work" may be speculation. You can speculate, but show the difference in your wording.

The next questions move beyond description. For an experience, give a short event and its consequence. For a wider question, state a view, explain it and illustrate it. Repeating the photograph description wastes the opportunity to develop the new prompt.

Part 3: compare on a meaningful dimension

Avoid describing Picture A fully and then Picture B with no connection. Choose a dimension: location, interaction, purpose, independence, access or effort. State one similarity and one significant difference, then explain what that difference may mean.

Useful flexible language: "Both involve...", "Whereas the first...", "The second seems more...", "One advantage might be...", "That would depend on...". Use only what the comparison needs.

Example move: "Both people are learning a practical skill, but one has immediate guidance while the other is working independently. The first may receive quicker feedback, whereas the second can choose their own pace." The comparison leads to a consequence rather than stopping at visible objects.

A photograph rarely proves which option is faster, cheaper or more successful. A strong answer can make a reasoned choice while acknowledging what is unknown.

Part 4: use the preparation minute to map the answer

Read all three prompts. Spend roughly 15 seconds identifying their demands, 25 seconds choosing one personal example and two main ideas, and 20 seconds arranging the order. Write keywords rather than sentences. Keep every prompt represented in the notes.

A useful two-minute route is experience (about 40 seconds), explanation or reflection (about 35 seconds), wider opinion with a qualification (about 40 seconds), and a short final link. These are practice guides, not extra official timing rules.

A framework for change: original situation -> trigger -> response -> result -> broader principle. A framework for evaluation: position -> reason -> example -> limitation -> judgement. Choose the framework after reading the questions.

Do not spend ninety seconds on the personal story and rush the abstract question. A rich story is useful only if it leaves time to fulfil the rest of the task.

Extend without rambling

Add a reason when the claim is unexplained. Add an example when the reason is abstract. Add a contrast when a judgement sounds too absolute. Stop adding detail when it no longer answers the question.

Weak extension: "It is useful, very useful, and important for many people." Better extension: "It is useful for people working shifts because they can choose when to participate. For example, a recorded introduction lets them prepare before attending a practical session."

If you run out of ideas, return to the question and ask which part remains unanswered. Repeating the opening with different adjectives rarely improves task fulfilment.

Self-correction, fluency and intelligibility

Correct an error briefly when it changes the meaning or is easy to repair: "last year - sorry, two years ago". Avoid restarting an entire answer to fix a minor article. Fluency includes continuing coherently after a small mistake.

Use pauses at idea boundaries. Speak at a pace that leaves room for clear word endings and stressed content words. A fast stream of words is not automatically fluent, and an unfamiliar accent is not automatically unclear.

When reviewing a recording, identify one place where the listener may lose the message. Is the cause an unclear reference, unfinished sentence, pronunciation, unnecessary detail or long silence? Repair that specific cause and record again once.

A focused feedback routine

After a full section, assess task fulfilment, organisation, fluency, grammar, vocabulary, intelligibility and timing. These are pedagogical review categories, not a calculation of an official Aptis score.

Choose three priorities: one content/organisation issue, one language pattern and one delivery issue supported by the recording. Write the exact exercise ID in the Error Tracker. Re-record a different response using the same improvement so that you test transfer rather than memorise a polished script.

Compact tutor command: "APTIS [ID] SPEAKING MODE. Use the attached prompts one at a time; no corrections during the section. I will control the timer. Afterwards give evidence and three priorities. Assess pronunciation only from audio."

Mini-drills | answers in the Complete Answer Book

MBS-E01 | BUILD A 30-SECOND REPLY

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBS-E01-Q01

Prompt: What helps you concentrate? Note a direct answer, a reason and one example. Then speak for 30 seconds.

MBS-E02 | SEPARATE OBSERVATION AND SPECULATION

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBS-E02-Q01

Brief: a person with a suitcase is looking at a station map. Give one observable statement and one cautious inference.

MBS-E03 | COMPARE THROUGH A PURPOSE

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBS-E03-Q01

Brief A: a person practises a language with a tutor. Brief B: a person uses a language app alone. Give a similarity, difference and consequence in 45 seconds.

MBS-E04 | PLAN ALL THREE PART 4 QUESTIONS

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBS-E04-Q01

One minute to plan, two minutes to answer: Tell me about a decision you reconsidered. What caused the change? Is changing your mind a sign of weakness?
